

Sweden's shift to battery-electric cars

Source: Trafikanalys new registrations, data through Aug 2026 (2026 = Jan–Aug). All owners unless stated.

Year

All

Fuel type

All

BEV share, rolling 12M (all owners)

39.7%

BEV share vs same period last year (all owners)

+6.5 pp

BEV share, private buyers

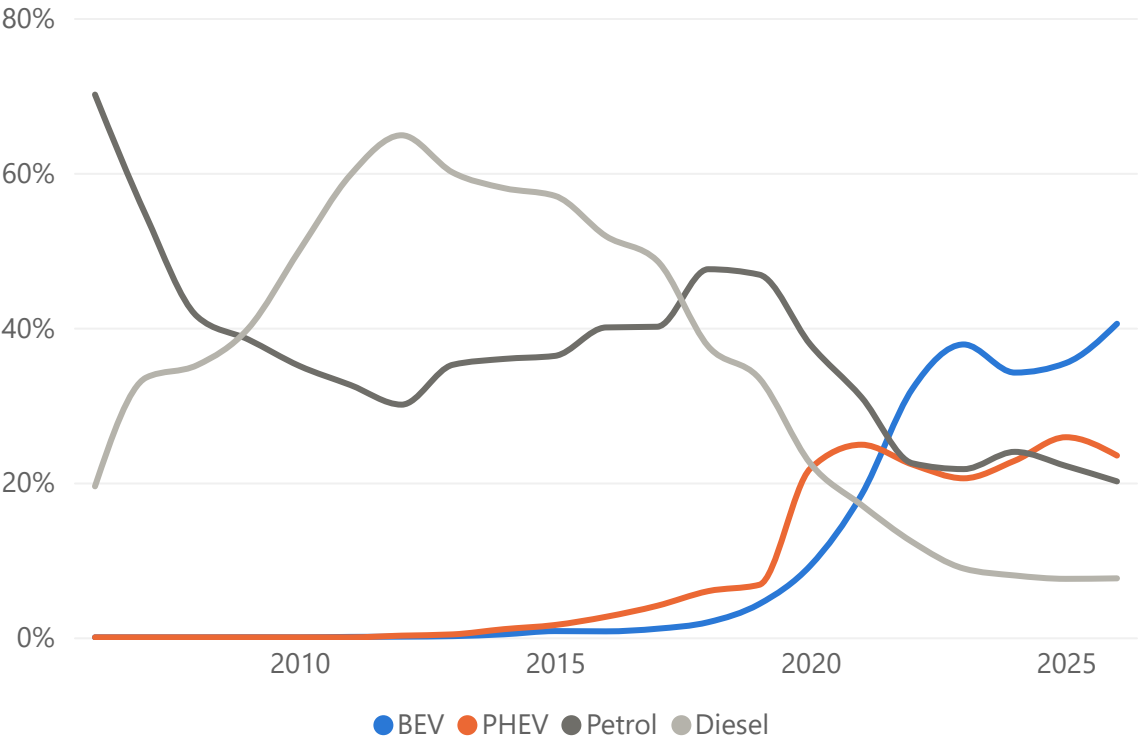
32.7%

New registrations (all owners)

2M

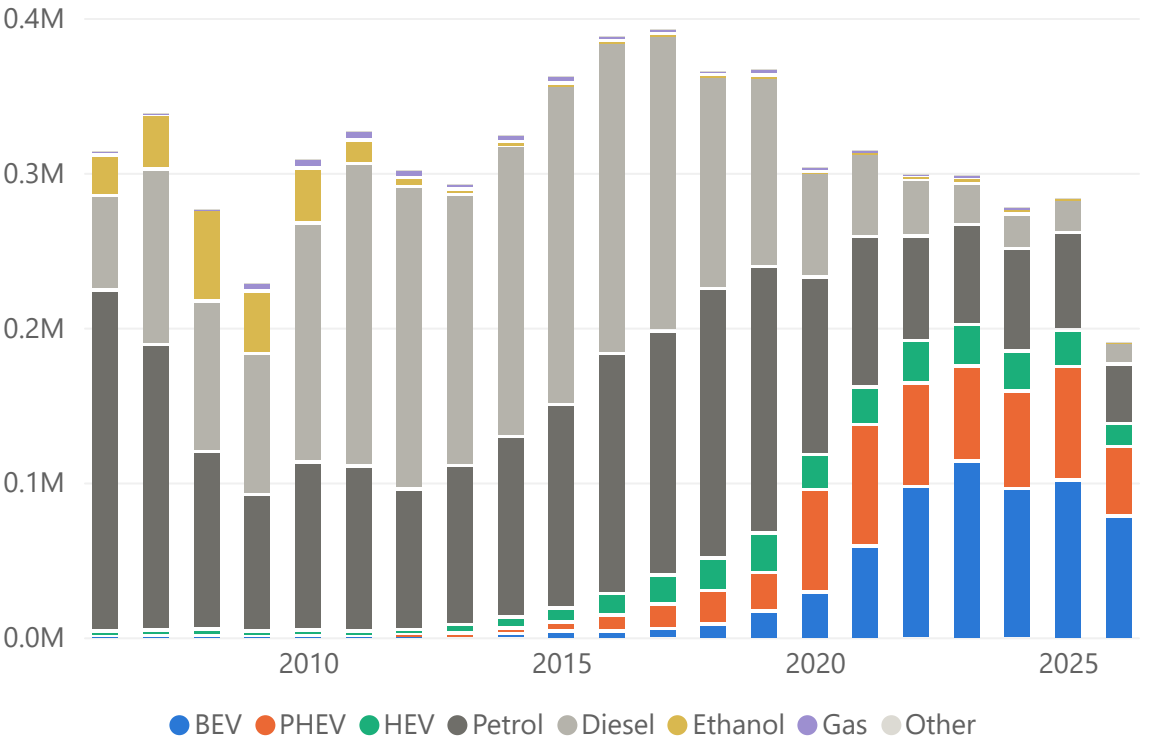
BEV share rose from 0.8% (2016) to 35.4% (2025) and 40.5% in Jan–Aug 2026; PHEV holds 20–26%

Share of new passenger cars by fuel, all owners, 2006–2026 (not filtered by Year)



The market shrank from ~390k cars (2016–17) to ~280k, while petrol and diesel gave way to plug-ins

New passenger-car registrations per year by fuel, all owners (2026 = Jan–Aug)



Buyers & seasonality

Source: Trafikanalys new registrations, data through Aug 2026 (2026 = Jan–Aug). Private and company buyers, 2021 onwards.

Year

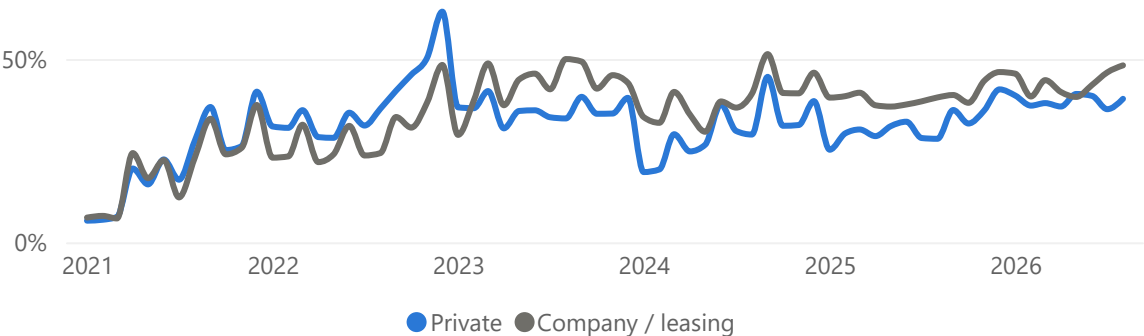
All

Owner type

All

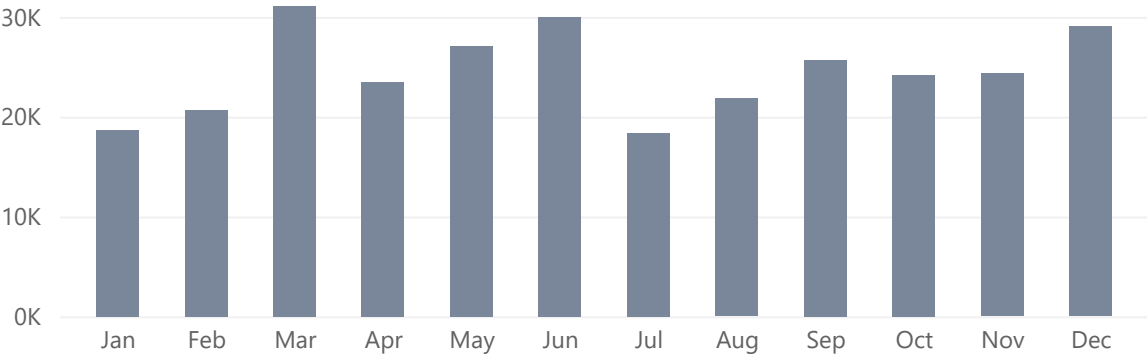
Companies have led private buyers on BEV share every year since 2023

Monthly BEV share of new cars by owner type, 2021 onwards



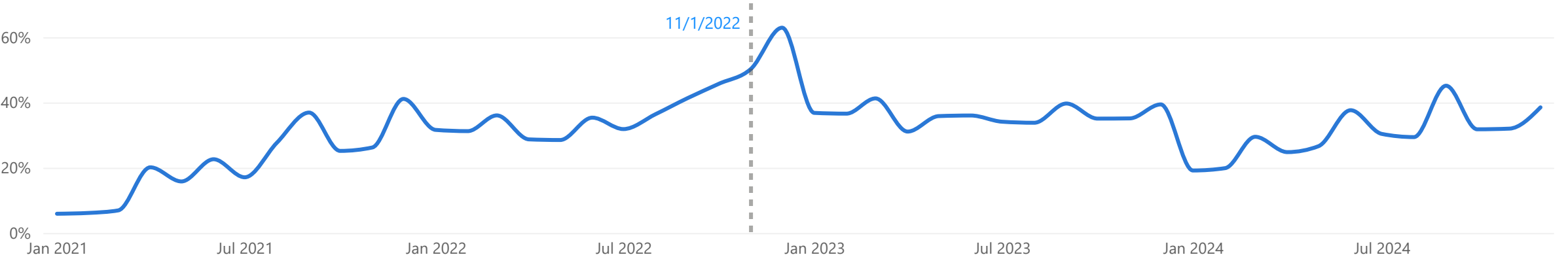
Registrations peak in March, June and December, and dip in January and July

Average new registrations per calendar month, 2021–2026 (filtered by Owner ty...



Private BEV share hit 63% in Dec 2022 as the bonus ended, then dropped to 37% in Jan 2023

Monthly BEV share, private buyers, Jan 2021 – Dec 2024



Where is the shift fastest or slowest?

Private buyers, Trafikanalys new registrations; Year slicer defaults to 2025, the latest full year

Year

2025

Region

All

Highest private BEV share

Halland & Västerbotten · 3...

Lowest private BEV share

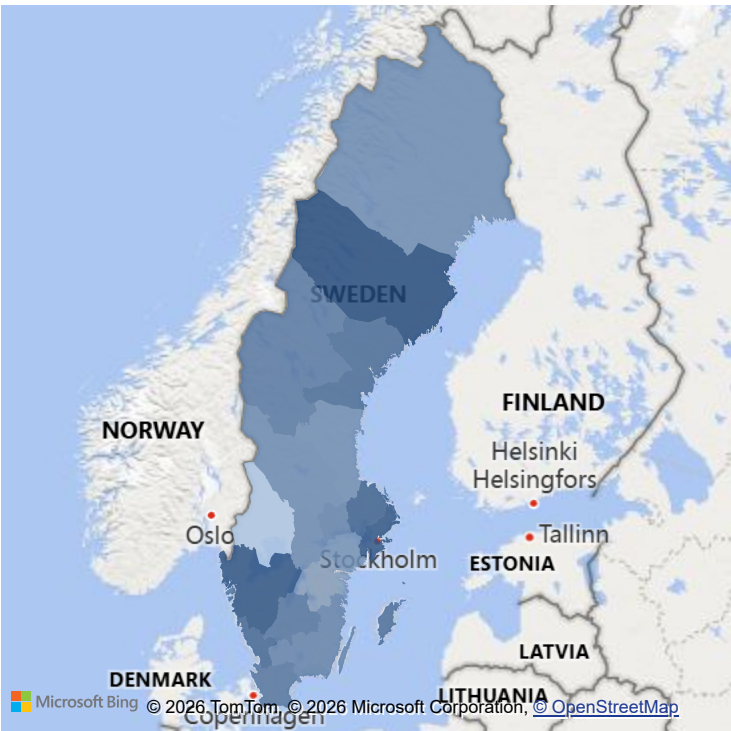
Värmland · 24.3%

Gap, highest vs lowest county

11.0 pp

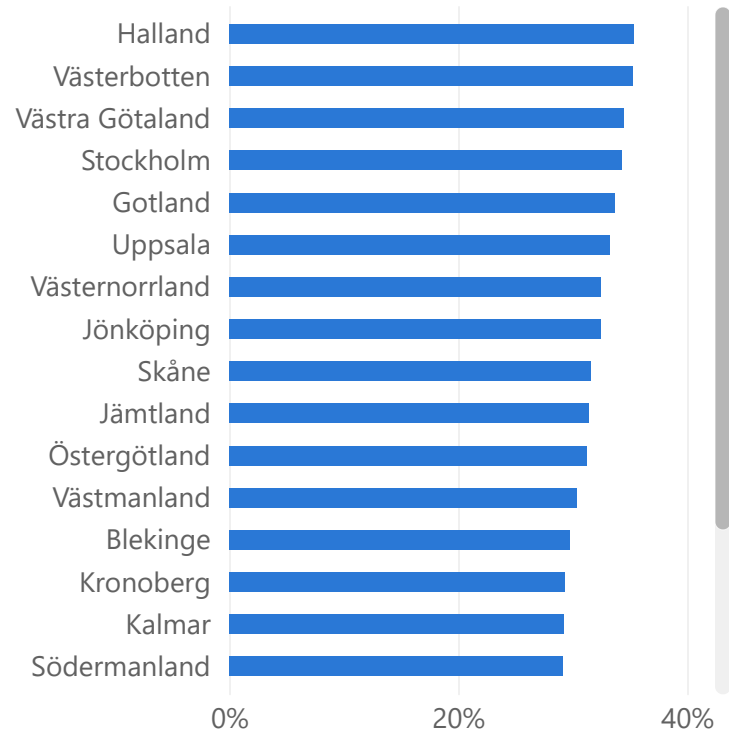
In 2025 the private BEV share ran from 24% (Värmland) to 35% (Halland, Västerbotten), with no simple north-south or city-country split

Private BEV share by county; darker = higher



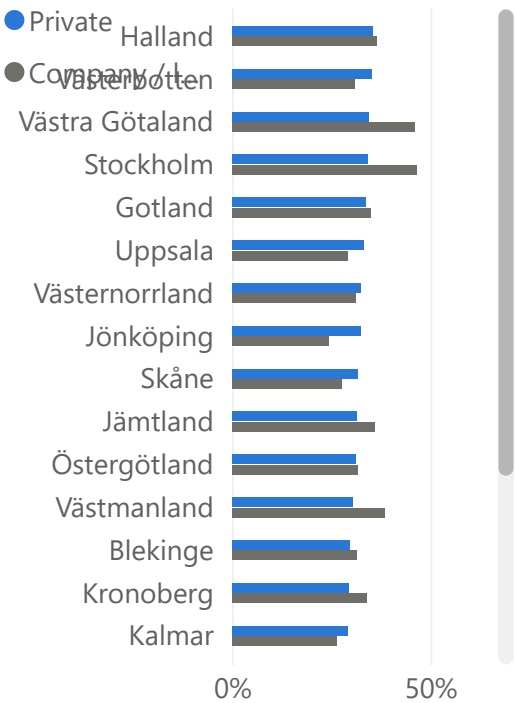
Only 11 pp separate the top and bottom counties in 2025; mid-table ranks are within noise

Counties ranked by private BEV share



Stockholm's company BEV share (46%) outruns its private share (34%); over half of Sweden's company and leasing cars are booked there

Private vs company BEV share by county; compan...



What goes with a higher BEV share?

Private buyers, Trafikanalys new registrations; Year slicer defaults to 2025, the latest full year

Year

2025

▼

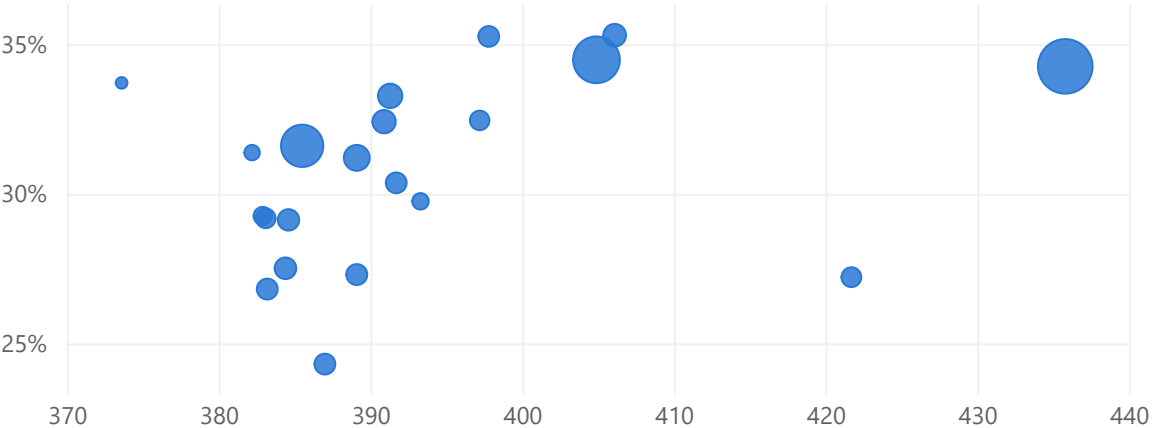
Region

All

▼

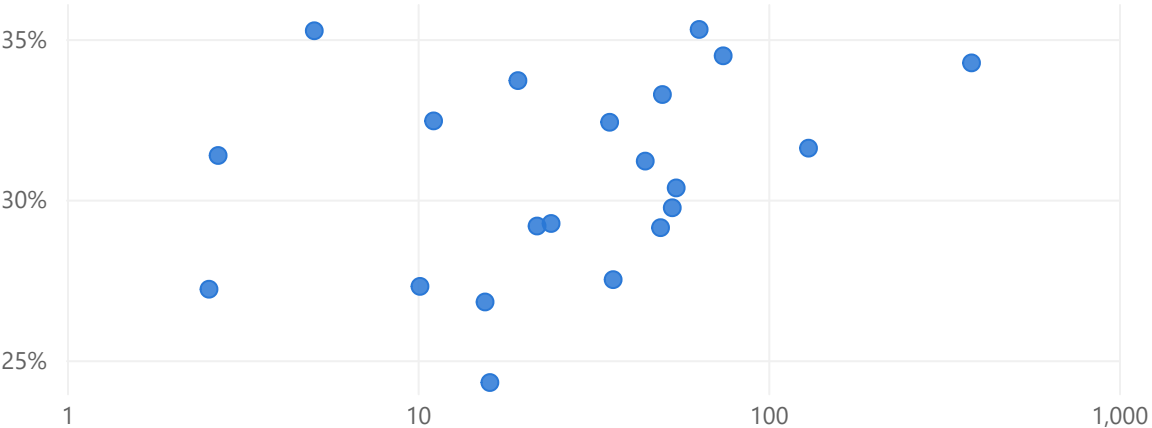
Higher-income counties buy more plug-ins: +10% median income $\approx$ +3.5 pp BEV share (+5.6 pp plug-in)

One point per county, sized by population; income is the previous year's (t-1)



Density adds little to the level once income is controlled; it shaped how hard counties swung after the bonus

One point per county; X axis on a log scale (2.5 to 380 people per km²)



Income is the only consistent level effect; density matters for the post-bonus swing

County panel 2021–2025, year fixed effects, county-clustered SEs (notebook 02)

Term	Effect	p-value	What it means
BEV share: +10% median income	+3.51 pp	0.018	A county with 10% higher median income (previous year) has a 3.5 percentage point higher BEV share
BEV share: 2× population density	-0.52 pp	0.201	A county with twice the population density has a 0.5 percentage point lower BEV share
Plug-in share: +10% median income	+5.61 pp	0.000	A county with 10% higher median income (previous year) has a 5.6 percentage point higher plug-in share
Plug-in share: 2× population density	-0.94 pp	0.039	A county with twice the population density has a 0.9 percentage point lower plug-in share
BEV share: 2× density × post-bonus (2023+)	+0.94 pp	0.034	After the bonus ended, each doubling of population density added 0.9 percentage points to the BEV share

Read with care

These are county-level patterns: they don't show that higher-income or rural households themselves behave this way (ecological fallacy).

What private BEV share is plausible by 2028?

Private buyers, national; scenarios from notebook 04 (state-space models on the logit share, trained Jan 2023 – Aug 2026)

2026 private BEV share (Jan–Aug actual + forecast)

41.1%

2028 central case (Plateau scenario)

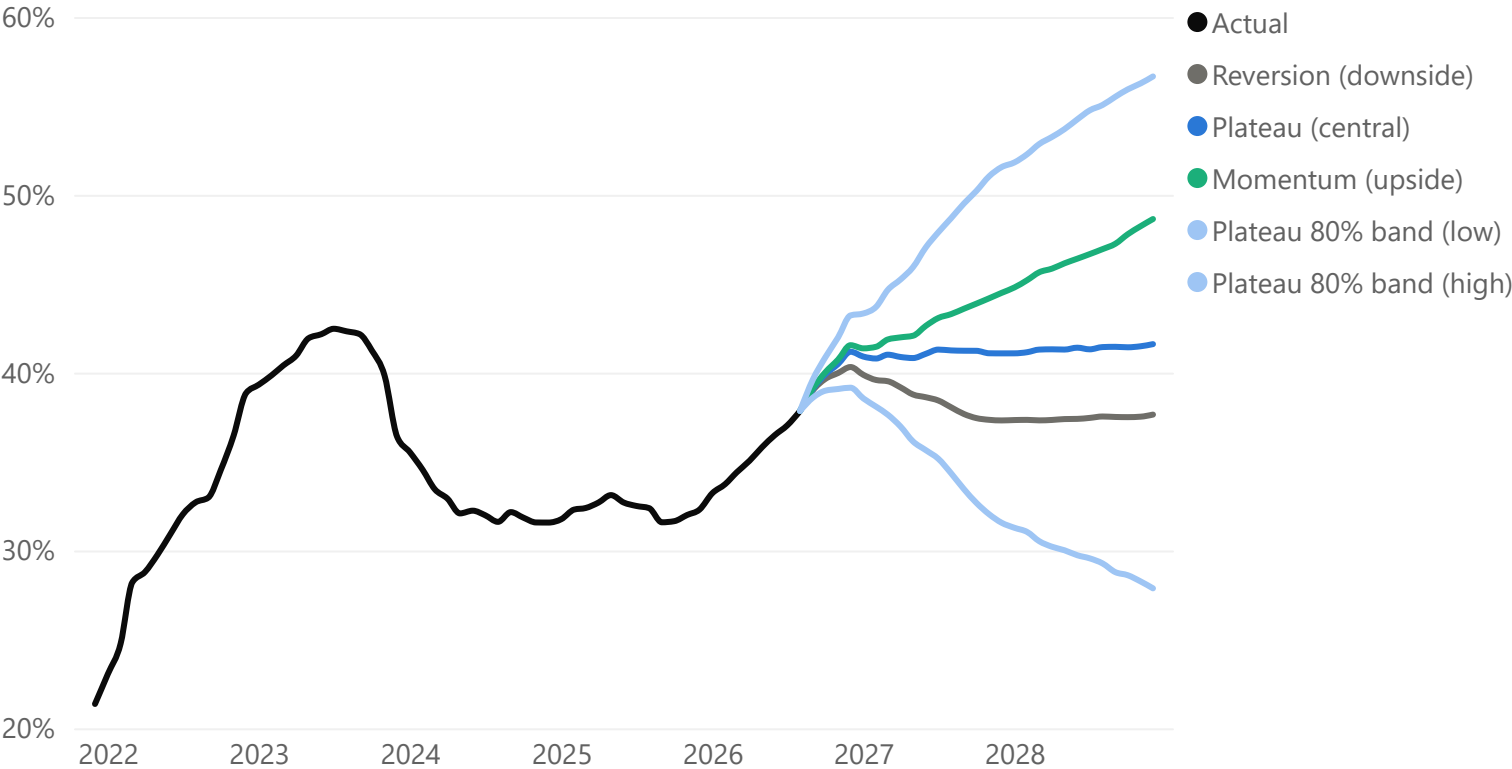
41.6%

2028 range across scenarios (downside–upside)

38%–49%

Central case: private BEV share holds around 42% through 2028; the scenarios span 38–49%

Rolling 12-month private BEV share: actual to Aug 2026, then scenario medians; light blue = Plateau 80% b...



2026 is nearly settled at about 41%; 2028 depends on which trend holds

Annual private BEV share (ratio of sums), median an...

Scenario	Year	Median	80% low	80% high
Plateau	2026	41.1%	39.1%	43.2%
Plateau	2027	41.1%	31.6%	51.6%
Plateau	2028	41.6%	27.9%	56.7%
Reversion	2026	40.3%	38.5%	42.1%

How to read the scenarios

Plateau (central): the 2026 level holds, no further growth.

Reversion (downside): the 2026 rise fades back to the flat post-bonus trend.

Momentum (upside): the 2026 restart continues along an S-curve. In backtests no model foresaw the 2026 restart, and models extrapolating a slope were wrong at both forecast origins, so treat the intervals as lower bounds on the real uncertainty.